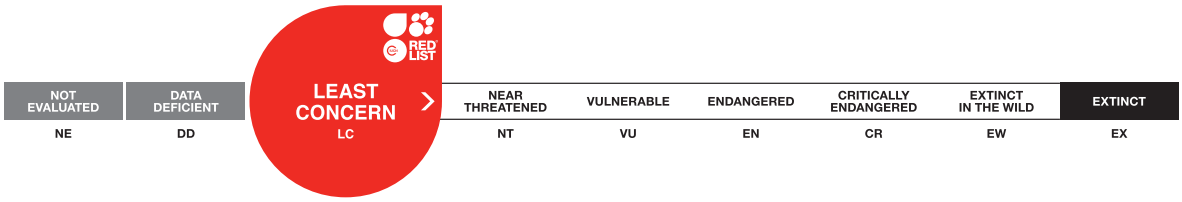
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Pantodon buchholzi, Freshwater Butterflyfish

Assessment by: Lalèyè, P. and Moelants, T.



View on www.iucnredlist.org

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Taxonomy

Kingdom	Phylum	Class	Order	Family
Animalia	Chordata	Actinopterygii	Osteoglossiformes	Pantodontidae

Scientific Name: *Pantodon buchholzi* Peters, 1876

Synonym(s):

- *Pantodon buchholzi Peters, 1876 var. macrolepis Brüning, 1911*
- *Pantodon buchholzi Peters, 1876 var. schizonotus Brüning, 1911*

Common Name(s):

- English: Freshwater Butterflyfish, Freshwater Butterfly fish
- French: Poisson papillon, Poisson volant
- German: Schmetterlingsfisch
- Swedish: Afrikansk fjärilsfisk
- Yoruba: Eleyan, Lapooti, Oloyan
- Hausa: Kakan kifi
- Czech: Motýlková ryba, Motýlkovec Africký, Ryba motýlek
- Polish: Motylowiec
- Finnish: Perhoskala
- Danish: Sommerfuglefisk

Taxonomic Source(s):

Fricke, R., Eschmeyer, W.N. and Van der Laan, R. (eds). 2020. Eschmeyer's Catalog of Fishes: genera, species, references. Updated 02 March 2020. Available at: http://researcharchive.calacademy.org/research/ichthyology/catalog/fishcatmain.asp.

Taxonomic Notes:

Recent molecular analyses indicate that *Pantodon buchholzi* is heterospecific (Lavoué in lit.) and further studies are needed to clarify the taxonomy and distribution of this species complex.

Assessment Information

Red List Category & Criteria: Least Concern ver 3.1

Year Published: 2020

Date Assessed: June 05 2019

Justification:

This species has a wide distribution, with no known major widespread threats. It is therefore listed as Least Concern.

Previously Published Red List Assessments

2010 – Least Concern (LC)

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Geographic Range

Range Description:

This species is patchily distributed from Benin to Chad, and south to Gabon.

Central Africa: It is known from Pool Malebo (Stanley Pool) upstream to Tanganga River, Lualaba River basin. Elsewhere, it is known from the Lower Guinea region from the Cross River (Nigeria), mouths of small coastal basins between the Cross and the Sanaga Rivers (Cameroon), and the southern part of the Ogowe (Gabon).

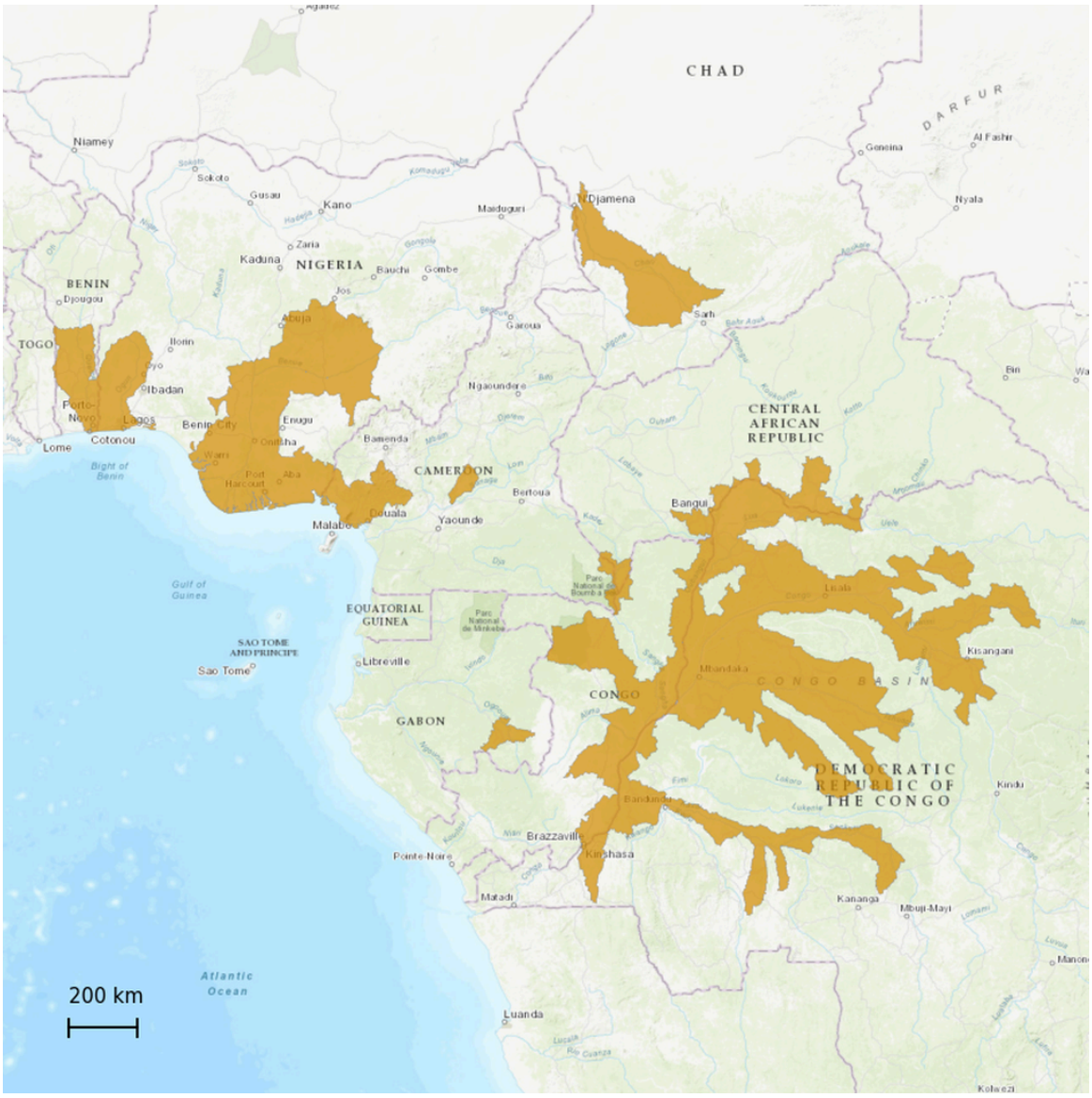
Western Africa: Specimens have been collected from Lower Cross Niger Delta (Imo and Osse) and Lower Ogun but the distribution seems to be much wider that this. It is also reported from Lokoja near the confluence of the Benue and Niger, the Lower Benue, Chari in the Chad basin, and Lower Oueme in Benin.

Country Occurrence:

Native, Extant (resident): Benin; Cameroon; Central African Republic; Chad; Congo; Congo, The Democratic Republic of the; Gabon; Nigeria

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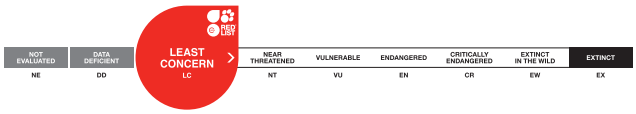
Distribution Map



Tiles (C) Esri -- Esri, DeLorme, NAVTEQ, TomTom, Intermap, iPC, USGS, FAO, NPS, NRCAN, GeoBase, Kadaster NL, Ordnance Survey, Esri Japan, METI, Esri China (Hong Kong), and the GIS User Community

Compiled by: IUCN (International Union for Conservation of Nature) 2019

EXTANT (RESIDENT)





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Population

No data are available on the population.

Current Population Trend: Unknown

Habitat and Ecology

(see Appendix for additional information)

This is a pelagic, potamodromous species. It is a species from calm waters (White 1994). It lives in swamps, creeks and backwaters (Olaosebikan and Raji 1998), and inhabits the calmer parts of rivers (Matthes 1964), where it can be seen on the surface waters (Gosse 1963). It is capable of jumping out of the water, to search for insects or to escape from predators (Teugels 1990). It is not a glider, but a ballistic jumper (Saidel *et al.* 2004), with a tremendous jumping power (Olaosebikan and Raji 1998). It is an exophageous insectivore, feeding on terrestrial insects and aquatic larvae and nymphs of insects (Matthes 1964). It also feeds on crustaceans and fish (Mills and Vevers 1989). It lays 80 to 220 eggs (Riehl and Baensch 1996).

Systems: Freshwater (=Inland waters)

Use and Trade

(see Appendix for additional information)

This species is harvested for human consumption, as well as the aquarium trade. It was introduced in 1905 to European aquarists (Arnold 1935, White 1994). It is a favourite fish for aquarists; in the aquarium it can rest with the top of the head and the large pectoral fins touching the surface, while the long rays of the pelvic fin hang down perpendicularly, forming a tempting morsel for other aggressive fish in the same tank, and therefore it should be stocked together with only bottom dwellers (Reed *et al.* 1967).

Threats

(see Appendix for additional information)

Harvesting for the aquarium trade may be a threat to this species, but it is not considered to be a threat to the global population.

Conservation Actions

No conservation actions are known to be in place for this species.

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Credits

Assessor(s): Lalèyè, P. and Moelants, T.

Reviewer(s): Sayer, C.

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Appendix

For more information on IUCN Classification Schemes referenced in this appendix, please visit: http://www.iucnredlist.org/technical-documents/classification-schemes

Habitats

Habitat	Season	Suitability	Major Importance?
5. Wetlands (inland) -> 5.1. Wetlands (inland) - Permanent Rivers/Streams/Creeks (includes waterfalls)	-	Suitable	-
5. Wetlands (inland) -> 5.2. Wetlands (inland) - Seasonal/Intermittent/Irregular Rivers/Streams/Creeks	-	Suitable	-
5. Wetlands (inland) -> 5.4. Wetlands (inland) - Bogs, Marshes, Swamps, Fens, Peatlands	-	Marginal	-
5. Wetlands (inland) -> 5.5. Wetlands (inland) - Permanent Freshwater Lakes (over 8ha)	-	Suitable	-
5. Wetlands (inland) -> 5.6. Wetlands (inland) - Seasonal/Intermittent Freshwater Lakes (over 8ha)	-	Marginal	-
5. Wetlands (inland) -> 5.7. Wetlands (inland) - Permanent Freshwater Marshes/Pools (under 8ha)	-	Suitable	-
5. Wetlands (inland) -> 5.8. Wetlands (inland) - Seasonal/Intermittent Freshwater Marshes/Pools (under 8ha)	-	Marginal	-

Use and Trade

End Use	Local	National	International
1. Food - human	No	No	No
13. Pets/display animals, horticulture	No	Yes	No

Threats

Threat	Timing	Scope	Severity
5. Biological resource use -> 5.4. Fishing & harvesting aquatic resources -> 5.4.1. Intentional use: (subsistence/small scale) [harvest] **Stresses:** 2. Species Stresses -> 2.1. Species mortality	Ongoing	-	-

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Additional Data Fields

Population
Population severely fragmented: No

Habitats and Ecology
Movement patterns: Full Migrant

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